Tutorial: Get Your First Wager Recommendations

This tutorial shows you how to use the Jeopardy! Wager Trainer for the first time. You enter one Final Jeopardy scenario and one Daily Double scenario. Each step gives the wager that the app shows, so you can check your screen against this page.

What you need

- A web browser.
- The live app at https://willhoop.github.io/jeopardy-wagering/app/, or the file `app/index.html` from this project.

The local file needs no internet access and no installation.

Step 1: Open the app

Open the live app. Or double-click `app/index.html`, or drag it into a browser window.

You see four tabs at the top: **Daily Double**, **Final Jeopardy**, **Quiz Me**, and **How This Works**.

Step 2: Enter a Final Jeopardy scenario

1. Click the **Final Jeopardy** tab.
2. Under "How many players?", click **3 players**.
3. Enter these scores:
4. Your score: **12000**
5. Opponent A score: **8000**
6. Opponent B score: **6000**
7. Set the confidence slider to **50%**.
8. Click **Get my wagers**.

Step 3: Read the results

The app shows two cards.

Safe Bet (Tier 1) shows **$4,001**. This is the smallest wager that beats each opponent outright if you answer correctly. Opponent A can reach $16,000 ($8,000 doubled). $12,000 + $4,001 = $16,001, one dollar more than that worst case.

Smart Bet (Tier 2) shows **$4,499**. Smart Bet uses your confidence and plays you against simulated contestants. A wager of $4,000 only ties Opponent A if they double up. A tie goes to a tiebreaker clue, so it

is worth about half a win. So Smart Bet bets at least $4,001.

Every wager from $4,001 to $4,499 gives the same win chance. Each one beats Opponent A's $16,000 if you are right. If you are wrong, you keep at least $7,501. That is more than the $7,500 that Opponent B gets with a $1,500 bet that is right. At $4,500, a wrong answer leaves you at $7,500, a tie, and the win chance goes down. When wagers give the same win chance, Smart Bet picks the one that wins you the most money. That is $4,499, the top of the range.

The Smart Bet card also shows a win chance. The chart under the cards shows the win chance for each wager. For the meaning of these percentages, read the Tier 2 section of `docs/white-paper.md`.

Move the confidence slider to **90%**. Click **Get my wagers** again. Smart Bet still shows **$4,499**, but the win chance goes up. Here, higher confidence does not change the wager. It changes how good that wager is.

Step 4: Enter a Daily Double scenario

1. Click the **Daily Double** tab.
2. Under "Round", click **Double Jeopardy**.
3. Under "How many rivals are in the game?", click **2 rivals**.
4. Enter these scores:
5. Your score: **4000**
6. Rival 1 score: **6000**
7. Rival 2 score: **3000**
8. Set "Daily Doubles still hidden after this one" to **None — this is the last one**.
9. Set "Money still in play on the board" to **Exact amount…** and type **0**.
10. Set the confidence slider to **70%**.
11. Click **Crunch the numbers**.

Step 5: Read the Daily Double result

The app recommends **$4,000**. This is your full score and the legal maximum here. Below the recommendation, you see a curve of win chance against wager.

In this scenario, no other wager is close to the best one, so the chart shows no shaded band. In other scenarios, the chart shows a gold shaded band. This band is the **plateau**: the simulation cannot separate the wagers inside it. The app then recommends the smallest wager in the band, because a larger wager in the band buys nothing that the simulation can detect. A wide band is expected behavior, not an error. One exception: wagers that give exactly the same result in every simulated game (for example, in solo practice) are chosen by money. If you are more likely right than wrong, the app picks the largest of them.

What you learned

- Safe Bet (Tier 1) needs no confidence number. It guarantees a win if you answer correctly, against the worst case of each rival.
- Smart Bet (Tier 2) and the Daily Double engine use your confidence and simulated contestants to find the wager with the best win chance. When several wagers give the same win chance, Smart Bet picks the one that wins the most money.
- A tie for first is worth about half a win, because a tiebreaker clue decides it.
- The Daily Double engine runs a simulation. When several wagers are too close to separate, it shows a plateau and recommends the smallest one.

Next steps

- Try the **Quiz Me** tab: see `docs/how-to/practice-with-quiz-mode.md`.
- Enter your own game's scores: see `docs/how-to/get-a-wager-recommendation.md`.
- Read the math and the results: `docs/white-paper.md`.